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WAM

■ Injured Palestinian children along with family members being evacuated by the UAE.

UAE conducts urgent medical evacuation of 155 Gaza patients

Wounded and ill Palestinians along with their family members evacuated

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE, in coordination with the World Health Organisation, has carried out a new medical evacuation of 155 wounded and ill Palestinians, along with their family members, from Gaza. The group was transported through Israel's Ramon Airport and via the Kerem Shalom border crossing.

The latest evacuation brings the total number of patients and relatives evacuated by the UAE to 2,785 since the beginning of the conflict. The new batch of medical evacuations is in line with the directives of President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan to provide treatment for 1,000 Palestinian children wounded in the conflict and 1,000 children

2,785

Number of patients and relatives UAE has evacuated so far

suffering from cancer. The initiative reflects the UAE's ongoing humanitarian drive to ease the suffering of civilians in Gaza and to curb the severe consequences of the humanitarian crisis.

Sultan Mohammad Al Shamsi, Assistant Minister of Foreign Affairs for Development and International Organisations and Vice-Chairman of the UAE Aid Agency, said the operation underscored the country's continued humanitarian response to urgently transport patients and injured civilians in Gaza. Al Shamsi said the operation comes as part of the UAE's long-standing commitment and its stand to support the Palestinian people "in all circumstances

and at all times," rooted in the nation's responsibility to deliver emergency aid and promote stability and ease the suffering of affected peoples due to wars and conflicts.

Emirati teams in action

The Emirati medical teams have transferred critical cases to hospitals across Abu Dhabi, while others, accompanied by their families, were taken to the Emirates Humanitarian City, where they are receiving care under the supervision of specialised staff. The UAE is also providing educational and cultural services to patients and their families to help ease the psychological burden of the war, particularly on children, women, and the elderly.

Alongside repeated evacuation missions, the country has established a floating hospital off the coast of Egypt's Al Arish, a field hospital in southern Gaza, and continues to provide medicines and essential medical supplies as part of its emergency response plan.

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Flyers take airlines to court over missing windows

Airlines sued over charging for 'blank wall'

DUBAI
BY ALEX ABRAHAM
Senior Associate Editor

Delta Air Lines and United Airlines are facing lawsuits from passengers who say they were charged extra for window seats, only to discover their seats were next to a blank wall.

The lawsuits, filed separately in US federal courts this week, accuse the two US carriers of deceiving customers and seek millions of dollars in damages on behalf of more than a million passengers of each airline.

The suits, filed by law firm Greenbaum Olbrantz LLP, allege that both airlines knowingly sell so-called window seats on some Boeing 737, Boeing 757 and Airbus A321 air-



craft that in fact have no windows, often because of the placement of air conditioning ducts or electrical components.

The complaints argue that both airlines "affirmatively" describe every wall-adjacent seat as a window seat, even when it lacks one, and that customers may be charged more than \$50 on United domestic flights – and more than \$70 on Delta – for such seats. On international flights, United passengers may pay as much as \$100 for a supposed window seat.

Motor insurance relief for EV owners in UAE

RECENT RENEWALS SEE EV OWNERS PAYING UP TO 9.5% LESS

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Owners of electric vehicles (EVs) in the UAE are seeing declines on the motor insurance premiums they have been paying on renewals in the last 15 months.

This will come as a huge relief for these car owners and, at the same time, be seen as crucial to expanding the sales of new EV models in the UAE.

Recent renewals have EV owners pay up to 9.5 per cent less compared to a year ago. On average, they are paying around Dh5,270 for a renewal – that compares with Dh5,815 on renewals done during Q2-2025 and Dh5,437 on average in Q1-25, according to data from InsuranceMarket.ae.

Healthy correction

"The correction during Q3-25 to Dh5,270 is healthy and reflects changes in the types of EVs being insured," said Avinash Babur, CEO of InsuranceMarket.ae. "There clearly is a more 'refined' understanding among

Dh5,270

Current EV motor insurance premium, down from Dh5,815

UAE insurers of the risks associated with this segment."

The drop in average motor premiums reflects the 'changing mix' of EVs being insured.

"What started with traditional EV brands like Tesla has now expanded to include a growing number of Chinese manufacturers," said Babur.

With many EV motor policies up for renewal in the coming weeks, the insurance premium declines couldn't have come at a better time for EV owners, especially after seeing significant spikes in what they had to pay on motor insurance after April 2024's rains and extensive damages caused to vehicles by the flooding.

In fact, there are many dealers who were grumbling about the impact high motor insurance rates was having on EV demand.

"Potential buyers are concerned that they will get an immediate hit on insurance after the first 12 months of car ownership, when they have free motor cover," said a source at a leading Chinese car dealer.

Under pressure

"At the same time, we are under pressure from the car brands we represent to do something to ease buyer concerns. If motor insurance rates on EVs are dropping, that's the best piece of news."

Even with these concerns, EV sales in the UAE continue to see increases, going by all the new Teslas, BYDs and other models featuring newly-issued number plates. And there are more Chinese brands that are taking chunks of new market share in EVs, through extended warranties and after-sales support. Dealers in EVs hope that these longer term warranties will ease buyers' worries about annual insurance premiums.

If the coming weeks show that there could be further declines in EV insurance rates, that will be more than enough for car owners and dealers.

FRIDAY
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